Social Context – Part 2
Project: OpenRefine

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After discussing the issues that each member selected in Part 1, our team decided on four issues that we believe are the best match for our current understanding of OpenRefine and our team goals. We wanted a balanced set of issues that includes frontend work, backend logic, clustering-related functionality, and debugging/testing opportunities.

1. Team Selection Criteria

While comparing our individual issue choices, we mainly focused on five ideas:

• Issues connected to systems we already studied in Assignment 2, especially clustering, reconciliation, and operation replay.
• Issues with manageable scope or clear reproduction steps.
• Issues where maintainers already discussed possible solutions or future directions.
• A mix of difficulty levels so the team is not working only on one type of task.
• Making sure every team member's interests were represented in the final selection.

These criteria are useful because our team is moving from architectural analysis into real contribution planning, so we wanted issues that are educational but still realistic for a student team.

2. Team Integration and Discussion

During the discussion, we compared all twelve issues proposed individually. One issue (#7330) appeared on more than one member's list, which helped us use it as a common starting point. From there, we selected additional issues that covered different parts of the system, including frontend UI behavior, clustering architecture, and operation replay/debugging.

This process helped us better understand how OpenRefine's frontend and backend systems work together, while also making sure the final selection reflected the viewpoints of the whole team.

#7330 – Improve stop-word handling: customizable and/or multi-language
Issue Link: https://github.com/OpenRefine/OpenRefine/issues/7330

This issue focuses on improving OpenRefine's stop-word handling so users can work with different languages instead of only English. Our team liked this issue because it connects directly to the clustering and fingerprinting systems we already studied. It is also labeled as a Good First Issue, making it realistic for a first contribution while still having meaningful user impact. This issue was originally proposed by Zhenyu and Kingson.

#289 – Clustering should be cancelable
Issue Link: https://github.com/OpenRefine/OpenRefine/issues/289

This issue addresses the fact that clustering computations continue running even after the clustering dialog is closed. We selected it because it is strongly related to the clustering subsystem analyzed in Assignment 2. It also introduces important software engineering concepts such as asynchronous processing, long-running tasks, and frontend/backend coordination. This issue was originally proposed by Zian.

#7760 – Backslash escaping regression in operation history
Issue Link: https://github.com/OpenRefine/OpenRefine/issues/7760

This issue involves a regression bug where certain GREL formulas fail when replayed from exported operation JSON. Our team selected it because it connects to the operation replay and parsing flow that we previously studied. It also gives us experience with debugging and writing regression tests. This issue was originally proposed by Zhenyu.

#6697 – Recon Suggest widget: middle-click to open URL in new tab
Issue Link: https://github.com/OpenRefine/OpenRefine/issues/6697

This issue focuses on improving the frontend reconciliation widget so middle-clicking opens a URL in a new tab instead of selecting the item. We chose it because it is smaller in scope and provides a good entry point for frontend contribution work. It also reflects Mouhamed's interest in frontend interaction and usability improvements. This issue was originally proposed by Mouhamed.

3. Conclusion

Overall, the four selected issues give our team a balanced roadmap for future contributions. Together they cover frontend usability, clustering architecture, operation replay, debugging, and reconciliation systems. The final selection reflects the combined viewpoints of all team members and aligns well with the technical areas we explored during Assignment 2.